Sucker Punch

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/45396073.

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Explicit

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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by TheStarGayzingEtherian

Summary

For the last few months, unbeknownst to her wife and friends, Catra has been sneaking off to the Crimson Waste to take part in an underground fight club. One night, during one of her matches, Catra finds her two separate worlds crossing over... and pays the price for her actions. (Catradora, Canon, Angst/Hurt/Comfort)

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

She knew this wasn't healthy. She knew this was wrong and possibly dangerous. But for Catra… well she didn't care. She was frustrated and angry about many things… and that anger needed an outlet. And she knew what happened when her anger wasn't let out somehow. People got hurt, sometimes people she cared about.

No, never again. This was just as much for their sake as it was for hers.

Now, she was riding on her speeder through the sands of the Crimson Waste, as the sun was setting. She knew the route well, having been partaking in this endeavour for several months by this point. She thought tonight would be no different, possibly slightly tougher than normal.

Fortunately for her, Catra was a very adaptable woman. She had to be. She'd been raised in the Horde after all, hurt and abused, having to manoeuvre herself into higher positions of power partly to keep herself safe. Now though… she *did* have a very safe comfortable life, one that she probably should have just stuck to living if she were honest.

However, the thing about trauma is… it never leaves you, not even for a moment. It sticks to you and horrible memories and feelings flash up when you least want them to. It can be such a burden to deal with, even with therapy, as Catra had been having with Perfuma these last few years.

But Perfuma's sessions could only do so much, as was the methods she'd taught her. As she approached her destination, Catra once again felt hesitation about what she was about to let herself do, what she risked by coming here. Wouldn't just feel better curling up with Adora in their suite in Brightmoon, safe and sound?

Maybe but… she wouldn't feel completely better. As much as she loved her wife and by Mara, she adored Adora… she knew she

couldn’t fix all her issues. She wouldn’t understand how better this helped her feel. No one could… and that was the reason why Catra didn’t bother telling them. Well, one of the reasons.

Finally, she arrived, her destination being a small town in the crimson waste in the middle of a large valley. She pulled her speeder up into a small alleyway, seeing a stairwell leading beneath one of the buildings. Climbing off her vehicle, she looked around to make sure she wasn’t being followed. She even checked all over the speeder's hull to make sure that no one had placed a tracking device on it.

Fortunately, it seemed as though she was in the clear and satisfied, Catra descended the steps and walked through a door in the nearby wall.

Descending another few flights of stairs, Catra soon found herself in a series of large catacombs… and her haven for the night. This place was an underground fight club, where people all over Etheria secretly fought and brawled one another, wanting to prove who was the strongest and toughest. There was a bar at the corner too, where Catra had fond memories of this point of getting completely drunk.

It was the greatest secret no one Etheria knew about, as far as Catra knew. Not even Huntara, the supposed leader of the Crimson Waste, knew a thing about this place. And Catra wanted to keep it that way. She knew the others would just spoil the fun Catra had here.

As she arrived in the arena, she saw a match going on in the large cage at the centre of the room. There was only one rule of the fight club. Two people went in and only one came out, either knocked unconscious or well… dead. Catra looked at her claws, knowing they’d spilt more than their fair share of blood in this ring.

They had it coming though. Most of these people were the worst of the scum of Etheria. She was doing the planet a favour by

ending their pathetic lives. Despite Adora and Glimmer insisting that everyone could be reasoned with, that people could always change their ways, Catra knew that was naive.

Not everyone had a secret good heart as she'd had, or be reasonable enough to admit they were wrong like Hordak and even Shadow Weaver to an extent. No, there were indeed some vicious horrible people in the world that loved to hurt others, who could never change no matter what.

And time and time again, Catra had been forced to let them slip by. Despite being the general in command of Brightmoon's military, the largest on Etheria, she felt she was constrained by so many rules and regulations, that Glimmer, as much as she liked her, wouldn't let her truly do what needed to be done to keep the people of Etheria safe.

But she knew that her reputation and position would only bring further problems with a place such as this. Which was why Catra wore a mask and hood to hide her identity. The mask resembled her old headpiece a little, red and feline-themed. If anyone suspected her true identity… well, Catra knew just how to deal with them.

"Glad you made it," a voice said.

A white and purple-scaled snakewoman walked over to Catra and the felid smiled. This was Szazi, a friend she'd made coming here to the club. She'd trusted her with her secret and Szazi would often give her hints on who her next opponent was. She'd been coming to this club for years and knew all the regular fighters.

In return for Szazi's help, Catra would split her winnings with her. This made their partnership very lucrative for Szazi, since Catra usually beat whoever she fought, though not without difficulty, of course.

"Quite packed in here tonight," Catra noted.

"Let's just say I might have slipped word that the Hell Tiger herself would be stopping by."

Catra chuckled. She hadn't come up with the name herself, just a nickname for her that had stuck. She did love it though, how powerful it sounded, how it called to the wild primal instincts that she worked so hard to hold back in her regular life… that she could unleash to the full here.

Hell Tiger… would Adora be pissed if she suggested that as a baby name for when they would have kids?

Looking at the arena before her, Catra eyed the two people fighting. One was a large crustacean, a Karikori if Catra remembered right, with huge pincers and the other was an orange-scaled Snakeman, wearing armour made of ancient metal. He was clearly winning, tripping his opponent up with his tail.

"Big lizard guy's gonna win this," Szazi stated. "He's been racking up wins all night."

"You know their names?"

"Crab guy's Clawful, big snakeman is Rattlor," Szazi stated.

Just then, Rattlor stabbed his tail right through Calwfu's chest with his tail, the crowd cheering as blood gushed from the deep wound. Clawful grunted and blood dripped from his lip as Rattlor removed his tail, Catra seeing that he'd replaced its rattle tip with a sharp, spiked blade.

"Correction, the crab guy *was* Clawful," Szazi remarked. "He didn't look like he was gonna last long."

"Is Rattlor a guy worth taking down?"

"Well, he's the brother of Tung Lashor, the guy you let die in that Quicksand all those years ago. He's a murderer, a sadist, part of one of those evil snake cults that's everywhere in this part of the desert. Oh, and he says he'd love to get to fight She-Ra one day."

“He’s not getting his hands on Adora,” Catra remarked. “Alright, I’m gonna take him. He’ll be a good warm-up.”

“Sure about that?”

“I’ve taken on tougher fuckers than him, I’ll be fine,” Catra reassured her friend.

As one of the gang members in the arena dragged Clawful’s corpse out of the cage, Rattlor roared and raised his arms in a boast of his victory, a prideful grin on his face, one Catra was going to have a lot of fun wiping off. He shook his tail proudly, his tongue flicking with anticipation.

“Who will challenge me?!” He declared. “Who will be the next to fall before Rattlor, Mightiest of the Snakes!”

“I’m afraid it’s going to be you who’ll fall, scale face,” Catra then remarked, walking into the spotlight. She put her hand on her hip and smirked at him.

Rattlor scowled. “Ah, the mighty Hell Tiger. I’d have thought you’d have been here tonight. I was counting on it.”

Catra unsheathed her claws. “Then what are we waiting for? Let’s dance, you big fuckugly lizard.”

The cage then closed behind her, the crowd cheering her on. Catra and Rattlor strafed the other, Catra narrowly considering her options. She knew Rattlor was bigger and tougher than her, but she had to bet he wasn’t smarter. She carefully considered her approach, knowing she’d need her brains more for this fight.

“Fight!” The announcer declared, as Rattlor then rushed at Catra, roaring.

Slashing his tail at Catra, Rattlor attempted to strike her right away. But Catra easily dodged the attack. Clinging to the side of the cage, Catra leapt up and clung onto the ceiling, kicking Rattlor

square in the face. Knocked back, the snake grunted and tried to grab Catra again, the felid slashing his face with her claws.

Having taken two hits from Catra, Rattlor was stunned for a moment, before he got his own back and managed to grab Catra by the arm. The felid yelped as she was tossed across the ring, and smacked into the other side of the cage. Catra coughed, watching as Rattlor strode towards her.

He laughed, but Catra knew he wouldn't be for long. Lunging again, she punched him hard, but he blocked the attack thanks to his giant wristguards. He attempted to stab her again with the blade on his tail, but once again Catra dodged it. He was learning her moves as he fought, a keen strategic mind.

Fortunately, Catra was also a tactical genius. She knew exactly what kind of buttons to push. But unfortunately for her though, Rattlor grabbed her by the neck and pinned her against the cage. She choked, feeling the burly lizard squeeze her neck, struggling to breathe. The snakeman laughed again.

"Looks like you die, kitty!" He mocked, before he leaned in and whispered. "And this is for my brother, Catra. Don't think I don't know who you are."

Catra's eyes widened and then she knew that this man definitely did not deserve to live. She then, with what strength she had left, bit down on his hand to the point she drew blood, fully biting off a chunk of his flesh. Rattlor groaned in pain, as Catra was freed from his grip, spitting out the bit of hand in her mouth. There was no holding back now, this snake *had* to die. Painfully.

Charging forward, Catra slashed Rattlor's chest with her claws, cleaving deeper wounds into the Snakeman's chest, pieces of bloodied scaled flesh hanging off his chest. Rattlor tried to fight back, thrusting his tail. However, this time, Catra managed to grab ahold of it tightly. With her arm and knee, she crushed down on the tail, until she heard the loud crack of bone. Then, with her

claws, slashed through the tail and broken bone, dismembering it from Rattlor in another gush of blood.

"My tail!" Rattlor screamed, as the severed tail fell to the floor, Catra having disarmed her opponent completely. And now, she had to finish him off.

As Rattlor clutched his broken tail, Catra rushed at him, striking his legs in just the right places to break them completely. Then, with all her primal strength, she dug her fist and claws right into Rattlor's chest, punching a hole clean through his body, with her fist coming out the other side in a bloody spurt.

Rattlor bled from his lip, his eyes widened. Then, Catra finished him, as she reached into his body… and ripped out the snakeman's still-beating heart. More blood flowed like a river out of Rattlor's body, as he slumped to the floor, dead. Catra panted, covered in blood, but still proud.

As the crowd cheered, Catra raised the snake's heart as a sign of her victory… and her reassurance that her secret was safe. For now.

After the match was over, Catra went to the bathroom at the back of the club to wash up and prepare for her next bout. She was tired, weary, the fight with Rattlor having taken a lot out of her. And yet, there was a part of her that was craving for more of this, craving for battle, for action.

The arena was like a drug. One bout in it sent a euphoric high through Catra that couldn't be satisfied anywhere else. And Catra knew she wasn't done yet. She removed her mask and hood, gazing at her real face in the mirror before her. Her face looked bruised and worn, she'd need to use a lot of makeup to hide this from Adora.

But such was the price to pay for this. That being said, she couldn't help but wonder how Rattlor had figured out her secret.

She took so many steps to ensure that no one would know she was here… and yet a random snake thug figured it out. Was there something she'd missed?

She couldn't worry about that now though. She still had to prepare for her next match.

Splashing some water on her face, Catra shook her head to keep herself awake and conscious. She'd taken quite a few nasty hits to the head during that last fight. She then began to wash her face, trying to mentally relax. Tonight was going to go just fine, she had nothing to worry about.

Finishing washing her face, Catra saw her weary face and eyes staring back at her in the broken mirror. At that moment she decided she was going to head home after her next match. Hopefully, Adora wouldn't notice she was gone too late. She looked over her shoulder at Sazi, who was keeping watch for her. She was glad there was one person here she could trust with her secret.

She remembered how they'd first met. Szazi had an abusive boyfriend who was a fighter in the ring when Catra first started coming to the arena. When Catra had beaten him in a match, knocking him out, she'd found him some time afterwards taking out his anger on poor Szazi… which was more than enough reason for Catra to slit his throat with her claws.

Szasi owed Catra her life from that moment on and promised to keep Catra's two lives a secret. Catra smiled at Szazi, knowing she couldn't have asked for a better friend. She reminded her a lot of Glimmer in some ways.

"Anyone coming to try and take a peek?" Catra asked.

"Nope, the folks here know not to fuck with you," Szazi stated.

"Just how I like it," Catra said.

Szazi chuckled. “You know, Catra…if your friends ever found out you were here… do you think they’d take it well?”

“No, which is why I come here wearing a mask and a hood,” Catra stated. “If no one recognises me, then no one can spill the beans to my friends.”

“Rattlor did.”

“Yeah but… he took the secret to his grave,” Catra said. “More than enough reason to kill him, beyond his own list of crimes.”

“Okay… but hypothetically, do you wonder about what your friends would think about you doing this whole thing?”

“Probably that I shouldn’t be doing this at all and I need to do something healthier. Or that I’m at risk of causing an incident with the whole Princess Alliance. Or I’m putting myself in danger of getting seriously hurt. That last part is probably definitely what my wife would think.”

“So why do you keep doing this?” The lizard woman then asked, curiously. “You’re practically the champion of the ring and yet, I rarely ever see you happy when you come here. I mean, I can tell you get some thrill out of it but… I don’t know.”

“Because I don’t do this for fun… I do this to feel something, to blow off steam, to get the anger and shit out of my system. Fighting those bastards out there… that’s fucking therapy for me. Plus if I kill a few bad people here… well, I guess that makes this a little worth it.”

“They weren’t kidding when they said you had issues.”

“I could write a whole book trilogy about my issues,” Catra snarked, putting her mask on again and wrapping some fresh bandages around her wrists. “Alright, who's my next opponent?”

“Prahvus The Malevolent,” Sazi explained. “One of the fiercest warlords in Etherian history. He even tried to take on Hordak and

his first second-in-command back in the day, but the Horde crushed him. These days, he picks fights in places like this, he's probably heard about how tough you are."

"Looks like I'm doing Etheria yet another favour," Catra remarked. "Any tips?"

"Well, he's really tough, like I said, the guy was a warlord after all. He might be the toughest son of a bitch you've fought here. But I know you love a challenge. Guy's an expert in combat and knows magic too, but he's not too powerful in that department. One thing you probably shouldn't do though is grab him by the horns. But knowing you, you'll do that anyway."

"What can I say, I like to fight dirty?" Catra said, as she then put on her mask and pulled up her hood. "Anything else?"

"Nope, I think you're good," Szazi stated. "Ready to give him hell, hon?"

"Is my wife the most powerful woman in the universe?" Catra sarcastically asked back. "Oh yeah, I'm ready to go kick his sorry ass."

Minutes later, Catra was in the cage again, which had been expanded to a large size to accommodate the battle that was to likely happen. She heard the cheers from the crowd and cracked her knuckles. Even if this Prahvus was her toughest opponent yet, she knew she could take him.

And by the night, she'd be presenting his severed head to the crowd, once again revelling in another bloody victory.

Then the crowd began to chant the name of Catra's opponent, hyping up what was clearly the match of the century. This was probably the most excited the crowd had ever been since she started fighting here. And then, with the sound of thunderous footsteps, Prahvus finally arrived.

He was a tall, grey-skinned man of a race Catra wasn't familiar with, who had a long black beard and a set of four horns growing from his head. Red eyes gazed at Catra, the warlord eyeing her carefully. He was extremely muscular, his bare chest covered in glowing green tattoos. Covering his shoulder was what appeared to be the skull of some kind of dragon-like creature, with a cape attached to it, with one of his hands covered by a black gauntlet with a crystal embedded in it, likely to focus his magic.

Prahvus stopped before Catra and smirked, before speaking in a deep, booming voice fitting of a warrior. "I have been looking forward to meeting you, Hell Tiger. Your reputation as a warrior precedes you. I have heard of your feats in slaying many fearsome opponents in this arena."

"You sound like a man of honour."

"I didn't get where I was without sticking to my beliefs and my code. I am not like these worthless dogs who merely pick fights for petty sport. There is no honour in that. But you… you are the most worthy opponent I have seen in a long time. I considered taking on She-Ra… but she doesn't nearly have as much blood on her hands as you."

Catra scowled. "Well, let's just say she has a belief that everyone deserves a second chance. She doesn't realise that sometimes killing is a necessary thing, in order to keep the world in balance."

"Agreed," Prahvus stated. "We share much in common it seems. I'd almost hate to kill you, but I suspect you wouldn't willingly follow my cause. No, you seem to still have too much of a moral compass for that."

"Yeah, I know you're a nasty motherfucker and the last thing I want is to follow men like you again," Catra said, baring her claws.

"Unfortunate… but, I shall let you know that when I do kill you, and I will, it shall be with a full warrior's respect."

“Oh yeah, well we’ll see about that won’t we?”

Prahvus’s gauntlet glowed with dark magic and he smirked. “Yes, I suppose we will.”

There was a moment of silence between the two combatants, as Catra strafed around the arena, calculating what her acts should be. She knew she needed to test Prahvus’s power, to know what she was up against. It was risky, but she knew that once she knew his strengths, she could easily take him out.

“Fight!” The announcer declared and then,

Catra rushed at Prahvus on all fours, growling. She leapt into the air and tried to slash the tall warrior with her claws. However, he merely blocked the attack with a magical barrier projected by his gauntlet, which he then used to push Catra back with great force. Catra skidded along the ground, glaring.

Her foe then smirked, raising his gauntlet again. He fired another blast of magic, causing an explosion right next to Catra. He kept firing again, trying to blast Catra but the felid kept dodging every one of his attacks. Catra tried to rush him again, but he tried to swing a punch at her.

“That all you got?” Catra snarked.

“I have barely started,” Prahvus boasted. His gauntlet glowed again, as did the tattoos on his chest. He took in a deep breath and then, as he exhaled, a massive burst of flame emerged, nearly singing Catra’s tail. The felid panted, sweat dripping from her head.

Of course this guy can breathe fucking fire! she groaned exasperatedly in her thoughts.

Prahvus chuckled, striding towards her calmly. He raised his gauntlet again, attempting to bind Catra in magical chains, but the felid managed to dodge those as well. She rushed again, realising she needed to stop fooling around. Prahvus clearly knew only the

basic spells… but his raw power was more than enough to give her a run for her money.

She slashed at him with his claws, trying his best to dodge his punches. Prahvus smirked, knowing he had Catra right where he wanted her. But Catra… she had the advantage now. She slashed at Prahvus right in the chest and he drew red blood from the wounds. He grunted.

"You… wounded me."

Catra just smirked and rushed at him again. She slashed at him again, striking his arm as he was distracted briefly. Prahvus grunted again, knocked back, giving Catra the chance to leap up and claw him right in the face. Her claws dug deep, she heard a sickening squelch as she left a deep wound across the warlord's eye.

The warrior roared in pain as Catra landed down. She thought this would be the beginning of the end. But instead, Prahvus just laughed. "Most impressive," he said, looking at Catra with his bloodied eye. "This is exactly the kind of ferocity I expected from you."

"Glad I didn't disappoint you, hornhead," Catra snarked, wiping the blood from her claws with her mouth.

Now that she'd seen what this warrior was clearly capable of, a plan of attack formed in Catra's head. Then she remembered what Szazi had said to her. She smirked, knowing exactly what to do. She rushed at Prahvus again. He threw a punch at her and she ducked it… and used it to climb up onto the man's back.

"Get down!" He roared.

"Why? Does the big bad bull not like being grabbed by the horns?" Catra mocked, before doing just that, grabbing Prahvus's horns. He roared and tried to throw Catra off, but the felid stayed in place, clinging on. She then led Prahvus towards the side of the cage, crashing him into it.

Prahvus grunted, pulling himself free. “Gah, you’ll pay for that!”

He then fired another series of explosive blasts at her, but once again Catra dodged them. Then it hit her what she needed to do next. He clearly seemed to be only able to use magic from his gauntlet… so that would need to be removed. She then rushed at Prahvus again and goaded him into punching her again.

He did, swinging another few punches at her like a giant trying to crush an ant. But as the fist with his gauntlet swung past her, Catra went into action. She brought out her claws again… and slashed right into Prahvus’s wrist. He grunted as he tried to shake her off, but Catra dug in… and then, her claws slit through bone, tendon and muscle, the man’s arm and the gauntlet coming off with one bloody slice.

Blood spewed from the raw stump that was on Prahvus’s arm. His eyes blazed red with a fearsome rage, his warrior’s demeanour having shattered and the warlord having given in to the wild beast he clearly kept repressed. He then growled at Catra fiercely, rushing at her at full speed.

Catra dodged his attack, watching his attacks. They were much more brutal now. He wasn’t even trying to fight with honour anymore. This was the worst dishonour the man had ever had and now he wanted Catra to die. Fortunately, she knew how to fight big dumb brutes like that

The felid ducked as Prahvus swung another punch her way, clinging to the side of the cage. Once again, the crowd was going wild for her and Prahvus was fuming. He didn’t like the fact that this smaller, weaker person was clearly getting the better of him, having literally disarmed him, and all Catra was doing was smirking back

“Ready to throw in the towel, hornhead?” Catra asked.

“Not a chance, furball!” Prahvus growled. “You think you’re so smart and have the edge, but I know you’re getting tired. It’s

been a long night and you're exhausted. You'll slip up and I'll take you down and just so you know, I won't even give you the honourable death you deserve. You should be put down like the animal you are!"

"Look who's talking!" Catra retorted, before she growled and charged back at Prahvus. He may have been strong, but he clearly wasn't big in the brains department. He thought his size and strength were everything and as such, he had a very simple pattern that Catra by this point had figured out.

She ducked under his fist again, slashing at his side with her claws. Prahvus roared in pain, charging straight at her. But Catra knew his moves by this point so well. She ducked to the edge of the cage and watched as Prahvus crashed straight into it, his horns getting stuck on the grate.

"Agh! Can't get out!"

Catra laughed mockingly. "You're pathetic. Prahvus The Malevolent? More like Prahvus The Moron! So much for being such a mighty warrior."

But just as Catra was celebrating her imminent victory, she looked into the crowd… and something caught her eyes. A pair of eyes beneath a hood, a pair of steel blue eyes, the only kind of eyes she'd ever seen on one person and one person alone. And standing next to those eyes was a similar hooded figure, whose eyes were purple.

No… No that couldn't have been them. Catra was sure of it. But then she vaguely was able to make out the blue-eyed person's cheek, and a distinctive set of three scars on it. Three scars made by her own claw marks.

"Adora…?" Catra whispered.

But suddenly, before Catra could say or do anything else, Prahvus freed himself and swung a punch right at her. To Catra's shock and horror, a large, light blue claw spike emerged from Prahvu's

remaining arm… and impaled her right through the chest and stomach with a massive bloody squelch.

Catra choked as the massive spike pushed through her body, blood oozing out of the wound from both sides. Blood seeped down her lip and she just stared in shock as Prahvus brought her face to face, the horned warrior smirking as he held her up, the crowd gasping in shock as Catra was dealt the final blow.

"You're not the only one with claws," Prahvus smirked menacingly, before he pushed her off, watching as she fell to the floor.

Her world going faint, Catra watched the world go hazy. She couldn't make out what was going on, but then, she heard the sound of a familiar voice screaming her name from the crowd.

"CATRA!!!!"

Her vision kept fading in and out and suddenly, the world went silent. In her last glimpses of the world, she saw Adora, blazing with golden magic and transforming into She-Ra tackling Prahvus through the cage and into a nearby wall… and then, Catra's world finally went completely black.

When Catra awoke, she was surprisingly alive. Her eyes fluttered open as she looked around, seeing she was in one of the crew quarters onboard Darla, in a scene very reminiscent of when Adora had rescued her from Horde Prime, which by this point, felt like a lifetime ago.

As she weakly sat up, she grunted and winced in pain, before she looked down, seeing she was in fact topless… with a massive red scar running down her chest. Though it looked healed, Catra still felt very sore and could barely move. She looked forward, seeing Adora in the doorway.

The expression on Adora's face was a look of concern, natural for her wife considering what Catra had been through. Yet, Catra was dreading what was going to happen next. Her secret was out and

she knew she'd be facing consequences for her actions, for lying to Adora, for putting herself at risk like this.

"Catra?" Adora asked, walking into the room. "Are you… Are you awake?"

"And surprised I'm not dead," Catra groaned. "What… What happened to me?"

"That bastard stabbed you right through the chest," Adora stated.

"I know, I was kinda there for that part, dummy," Catra snarked in her usual manner, her humour deflecting the excruciating pain she was feeling. "What happened after I blacked out?"

"Adora straight up killed the guy," Glimmer then said walking into the room. She didn't share Adora's concerned look at Catra. "Trust me, your wife is terrifying when she's angry. She pushed him through a wall and beat him to a bloody pulp with her bare hands. Her hand went clean through the guy's head."

"And… and the arena?"

"Huntara's goons and your guards arrived and we arrested pretty much everyone," Glimmer explained. "Some of them got away though. But well… that's not important is it, Catra?"

Adora then glared at Catra too. "How could you do it Catra? How could you put yourself at risk like that?"

"So you know everything?"

"Your friend Szazi told us the whole story," Glimmer said. "I… I can't believe this. I thought you were better than this, Catra."

"Guess you were wrong, Sparkles," Catra replied, looking away. "I did it to feel better, okay? It's all fine and dandy being in Brightmoon with you two, but I miss going out there and kicking people's asses. And trust me, the fuckers I was killing in that arena deserved it. I did the planet a favour."

“But you’re the general of my royal guard!” Glimmer argued. “How is it going to look when people find out you were straight-up murdering people out here?!”

“They deserved it! You were just too chickenshit to do it yourselves!”

Glimmer sighed, looking down. “We’ll… We’ll deal with you when we get back home. Right now, you need your rest.”

As Glimmer took her leave, Adora looked away and sighed. She then walked over to Catra and sat down on the bed, still not making eye contact. The two wives were silent for a few moments, neither of them really sure what to say. All they knew was that Catra had broken Adora’s trust… and that hurt her.

“Are you… going to stay?”

“Yes, despite every reason why I shouldn’t,” Adora said. “You could have died tonight, Catra. I already nearly lost you once. It took so much of my magic to keep you alive and even then, I couldn’t heal your wound completely.”

Catra chuckled. “At least I get an awesome scar, right?”

“You don’t get to joke, Catra!” Adora shouted, not in the mood for her wife’s banter. “You’re lucky I was there tonight, that we’d been onto you for a while. If I hadn’t been there… if…” She started to cry. “God, Catra… I don’t know what I would have done if I’d lost you. Do you know how much pain I’ve been through because of this?”

The felid retreated and she sighed. Her wife… was right. She had put them both through too much pain. No matter how good fighting and killing had made her feel… she’d still nearly died tonight. And nothing was worth dying over, was worth losing Adora over. The tears formed in her eyes and Catra finally admitted she was wrong.

"Yes, and I'm… I'm so fucking sorry," Catra sobbed. "I… I should never have started doing the stupid fights. Even if it was worth it by killing bastards like Prahvus, I… I was wrong. I was risking my life and I nearly lost that tonight… and you."

As both wives cried, Adora knew she couldn't be angry at Catra forever and pulled her into a soft and loving embrace. She held her gently though, not wanting to add to the felid's pain. Catra just cried, before she eventually breathed easily and looked into Adora's eyes, accepting her fate.

"I'll… I'll go through whatever punishment Sparkles has in mind for me," Catra said. "I deserve it."

"Catra…" Adora sighed. "Glimmer and I haven't decided if you're going to be punished."

"But… she seemed pretty angry."

"She is angry… but we still love you. And we know you've already been through enough with this whole thing." Adora looked at Catra. "And then there's one other thing I've just realised."

"And what's that?"

"Well… no one actually saw you without your mask there, other than that friend of yours," Adora admitted. "And the noise in there was so deafening that no one would have been able to make out me calling your name when you got stabbed. And then everything was pretty chaotic afterwards so I bet barely anyone noticed Glimmer teleporting you back to the ship."

"So… are you saying I could get away with it?"

"Possibly," Adora said. "You'd… need to promise you'd never do a stupid thing like this again though."

"I promise," Catra said, seriously. "I… I know better."

Adora smiled, before she kissed Catra. "Okay… I should let you rest. I… I love you, Catra."

"And I love you, Adora," Catra replied, smiling hopefully. "And Adora? Thanks… for killing that fucker for me."

"Like you said, he deserved it," Adora responded as she walked out of the room. She smirked a little, looking at Catra. "He did nearly kill my wife after all."

And with that Adora left Catra in peace and the felid sighed and rested back in her bed. It was going to be a long flight back to Brightmoon… but Catra didn't mind. She was just glad to be alive, glad to be safe… and knew that her career as a fighter was over by this point. It wasn't all bad though… because life was worth it as long as Catra had Adora, the woman she would always love.

End Notes

Hooo boy this was definitely a long one, but it was sure as hell fun to write. I think this fic really pushed me writing action scenes to their limit if I'm honest. Also, if you're wondering who Prahvus is, he's a background character from the 2002 He-Man cartoon. I only chose him for this because well... he had a kinda cool design lol. Rattlor and Clawful should be more than familiar to He-Man fans reading this.

If you liked the fic, please be sure to comment!

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